JAYDEV BALOLIYA

Senior iOS Engineer
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SUMMARY

iOS engineer with over 10 years of experience, most recently on Rakuten Kakeibo, a personal finance app with millions of users (contract ended August 2026; available to start now). Most of my work is native iOS in Swift and Objective-C, and I've shipped apps across finance, retail, travel and a few other areas. I like owning a feature end to end - from the first spec discussion through testing and release - and I care about the parts that are easy to skip: refactoring, reviews, and keeping things stable and fast. I've also picked up some cross-platform (Flutter) and backend (Rails) work along the way, and I build AI agents that take on real development work. Based in Japan for the last several years, working in English and Japanese day to day (studying toward N3).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Swift, Objective-C, and some Python, JavaScript and SQL

iOS: UIKit (most of my experience), SwiftUI, Foundation and the standard iOS SDK, Combine, some Swift Concurrency (async/await), Core Data, SQLite, GCD and threading, memory management, app lifecycle, push notifications

Architecture: MVVM and MVC mainly, with Clean Architecture on larger projects; the usual patterns (delegation, observer, dependency injection); in-house CocoaPods libraries for shared code; offline-first design; keeping modules separated so a team can work in parallel

Testing and quality: Unit tests with XCTest, code review on GitHub, continuous refactoring, writing specs and documentation

Product and analytics: Crash log and user-behaviour analysis, analytics and deeplinks (Adjust, Firebase), feature flags, A/B testing, iterating from production data

Performance: Instruments for memory and time profiling, finding and fixing retain cycles and leaks, crash log analysis, keeping large data-heavy screens smooth

Tooling and release: Git (GitHub, Bitbucket), CI with Bitrise and Fastlane, App Store Connect and TestFlight, provisioning and signing, CocoaPods and SPM, Jira, Confluence, Firebase

AI-assisted development: Claude, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex, MCP servers; building agents that investigate, plan and implement tasks with a human review step

Cross-platform and web: Flutter (built a full messaging app - chat, voice/video calls, media), a bit of Kotlin, and Ruby on Rails (a 3-page CRUD app - views, routing, database operations)

Hardware and protocols: BLE and iBeacon (Core Bluetooth), UDP sockets and IR protocols - hands-on client-side work controlling and communicating with devices

Cloud and DevOps: Microsoft Azure - DevOps (Pipelines, Repos, Boards, Wiki), building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines for automated build, test and deployment, cloud-based deployments; Firebase (Auth, Firestore, Storage, Crashlytics); Vercel serverless deployment; AWS fundamentals; Bitrise and Fastlane for mobile CI/CD

Data and BI: SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server), Ruby on Rails with ActiveRecord, and BI tooling in VBA that cut a client's operational costs by ~25%

EXPERIENCE

Senior iOS Engineer - Rakuten Kakeibo (Rakuten Group)

Contract through Randstad Japan | Tokyo | Sep 2023 - Aug 2026 | Team of 4 iOS engineers

- Worked across the full cycle on the Kakeibo app - specs and documentation, coding, unit tests, and releases - mostly in UIKit.
- Covered the team lead role for about six months while our lead was on extended leave - requirements gathering, estimation, sprint planning, QA coordination and release management. Not my title, but nobody else picked it up and we kept shipping without delays.
- Built an AI agent that implements task tickets. It first investigates the scope and reports which files and areas will change, with points for us to confirm; only after we approve does it write the code. About 90% of tasks came out matching our coding standards and designs, and we fixed the other ~10% ourselves.
- Handled the parts of a finance app that are easy to get wrong: pulling in bank and card data, dealing with partial syncs and failed refreshes, and reconciling mismatches. A lot of the work was in the error and edge cases, not the happy path.
- Kept the data-heavy screens (transaction lists, charts, category breakdowns) fast as the amount of data grew, using Instruments to track down memory and performance problems.
- Did code reviews on GitHub, refactored older parts of the codebase, and helped keep our Bitrise CI setup working so builds and tests stayed fast.

- Looked at crash logs and analytics to figure out what was actually affecting users, then proposed and built the fixes.
- Mentored the junior engineers on the team, while still owning the design decisions and reviews myself.

Tech: Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Combine, MVVM, Clean Architecture, Core Data, XCTest, Bitrise, GitHub, Firebase, Adjust, Jira, Confluence, Claude

Senior iOS Developer - VeBuIn Corporation

Tsukuba, Ibaraki | Feb 2020 - Aug 2023 | Team of 8 (3 iOS, 2 backend, 1 QA, 1 designer, 1 frontend)

- Led iOS delivery for enterprise clients (JERA and Right-On) on an 8-person project, usually working on site with the client from requirements through release. Also covered the backend and QA leads, so I was coordinating across all three.
- JERA: got the crash rate down about 20% in six months - memory profiling, fixing leaks, adding tests where they were missing, and tracking down a crash the logs couldn't explain, which came from custom drawing code and data conversion on a background thread.
- Right-On: cut an API's response time from 8 seconds to 2 in Ruby on Rails by adding pagination, splitting the list and detail APIs, and loading more data only when the user asks for it.
- Built and maintained in-house CocoaPods libraries to modularize shared code across the client apps - versioning them and keeping the API stable for the other developers using them.
- Also built a small Ruby on Rails web app end to end, and some BI tooling in VBA that saved the client around 25% on operational costs. Spent time cleaning up legacy Objective-C too.
- Set up and maintained the Azure DevOps side of things - CI/CD pipelines for automated build, test and deployment, plus repos, boards and wiki for the team. Handled the cloud deployment side of releases.

Tech: Swift, Objective-C, UIKit, SwiftUI, MVC, MVVM, XCTest, Xcode, GitHub, Firebase, Azure DevOps and Pipelines, Fastlane, Ruby on Rails, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), WKWebView

iOS Developer - ThinkBiz Technology

Ahmedabad, India | Dec 2018 - Feb 2020

- Built a driver-safety feature for Daihatsu's app using iBeacon and BLE, including a voice-activated emergency call for when the driver can't touch the phone.
- Worked on SmartFlow, an expense and HR app that shipped to the App Store and cut manual work in half.

Tech: Swift, MVC, iBeacon, BLE, Core Data, Firebase, Bitbucket, Xcode

iOS Developer - WebPixel Technologies

Ahmedabad, India | Feb 2017 - Dec 2018

- Shipped five apps to the App Store - travel and hotel booking, an artist-booking app with chat, a QR rewards app, and CrewDox, a training and compliance app built offline-first so it kept working in places with unreliable network.

Tech: Swift, MVC, RESTful APIs, SQLite, Firebase, Xcode

iOS Developer - SMN Digital Consultancy

Ahmedabad, India | Dec 2015 - Feb 2017

- First iOS job. Built a home automation app that controlled lights, AC and media over UDP, plus a handful of education apps for kids.

Tech: Swift, MVC, UDP sockets, IR protocols, IoT, SQLite, Core Data, Xcode

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Messaging app (Flutter, Firebase, LiveKit) - built the whole thing: one-to-one and group chat with real-time sync, voice and video calls including group calls, stories and media. Ran on iOS and Android from one codebase. Built it quickly with AI tools, since Flutter isn't my main stack.
- Kaiwa Coach - an AI conversation partner I built to practise speaking Japanese. I use it regularly to keep improving my level.
- A few AI agents in Python on the Claude API - scheduled jobs that do research and reporting with web search, keeping state between runs. Also use MCP server integrations in my day-to-day setup.

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

Bachelor of Computer Applications - Gujarat Technological University, Ahmedabad (2009-2012)

English (fluent), Japanese (studying toward N3), Hindi and Gujarati (native)